hearing about those prayers other people were saying for me.

Besides our privacy and the ranch, another thing I had to give up after my decision to run for governor was my aversion to flying. Prior to the election, I was still committed to give a few speeches out of the state including a pair in Texas—in El Paso and Fort Worth. I asked the staff to book me on the train from Los Angeles to El Paso and then arrange for a bedroom on a night train from El Paso to Fort Worth that I'd taken previously. They got back to me and said the night train now had only day coaches, no berths. I decided I didn't want to sit up all night in a coach and then remembered what I'd always told myself: The day would come when something would happen that would make me realize it was time to fly.

The time had come, I decided. I asked the staff to get me a ticket on the train to El Paso and the morning plane from El Paso to Fort Worth. There was a long silence on the other end of the phone. They had never heard me say that before. But I assured them I really meant what I said and they made the arrangements. I picked up my tickets and was driving home when I stopped at a signal on Sunset Boulevard and bought an afternoon paper from a newsboy. As I waited for the light to change, I placed the paper down on the seat beside me and studied the front page: There was a story about an airliner that the day before had lost a wheel on takeoff in El Paso and had had to circle the airport at Fort Worth while it emptied its fuel and emergency crews spread foam on the runway, before making a belly landing. It was the same flight for which I had just picked up a ticket. When I read the story, I remember looking up and saying aloud: "Make up your mind." But I took the plane and got to Fort Worth safely and from then on, there would be lots of airplanes in my life.